

UNTITLED SCREENPLAY

My Name Here

The front door. Sandals thrown about around a dirty welcome mat. Next to the door, a window--shades drawn, light bleeding through the cracks.

A figure walks past the window. Three knocks. No response.

Another three knocks.

MALE VOICE (O.S.)
Yeah, yeah! Coming!

BRICK(30s, blonde) stumbles into view, shorts around his ankles. He hobbles towards the door, tugs his basketball shorts up to his waist.

Brick wears a Miami Dolphins Tagovialoa jersey, his long blonde hair tied into a bun, a couple days unwashed.

He opens the door. JERRY LEFTON(30s) stands there--unwashed jacket, with slacks, tie and shoes to match. Everyting coordinates. Nothing's clean.

JERRY
Oh-uh. Brandin Garrity, right?

BRICK
Yeah, Whatsup?

Brick shields his eyes from the sunlight.

JERRY
It's Jerry Lefton, I don't know if you remember. From high school?

Brick rubs his eyes and leans forward to get a better look.

BRICK
Holy shit! Jerry? Shit, what's going on dude?

JERRY
Oh, well doing fine I-

BRICK
Goddamn! Sorry, I just- It's been forever dude! What're doing here?

JERRY
Um, actually if it's okay, I just wanted to catch up, ask a few questions actually-

BRICK
Oh, yeah totally. Uh-ah shit where
are my manners man?

JERRY
(surprised)
Oh, really? We can talk here-I can
be quick if you're.

BRICK
Nah, totally! I insist man...God
knows I could use the company.

Brick looks Jerry up and down. Then waves him inside.

2 APARTMENT LIVING AREA

2

Jerry steps inside. The door closes behind him.

Jerry chops his feet on the welcome mat, he ends up just
kicking more dirt lose. It reads: WELCOME TO THE MAN CAVE.

Brick is already in the kitchen, connected to the living
room to the left of Jerry.

BRICK (O.S.)
Lemme get you a cold one!

JERRY
Oh no thanks, I'm good.

BRICK (O.S.)
(scoffs)
Ah cmon man. I'm gonna get you one
anyways.

JERRY
No really, thanks for the offer
though.

BRICK (O.S.)
Naww, I cant let you-

JERRY
I don't drink Brick.

Brick grabs a beer from the fridge. He moves into the
living room.

BRICK
Uh-huh. Whatever dude.

Couch, loveseat, coffee table--all facing a TV propped up
against a wall. Above it: Playboy centerfolds, carefully
arranged, all nude.

The coffee table is scattered with dirty napkins and empty beer cans.

BRICK

Take a seat dude. Make yourself at home.

Brick plops down in the loveseat. Dust billows up around him.

BRICK

See you lookin' at my girls. Like 'em?

JERRY

Sorry? Oh, you mean, uh- yeah.

BRICK

I see ya sneaking a peek, Hah! Don't worry I put em up there for a reason.

JERRY

I was just looking around.

BRICK

Oh, I bet you are.

Brick cracks open his beer can. Jerry grabs something from his pocket.

JERRY

Just admiring your place, it's-uh-nice you could find somewhere. It, uh, looks... Good.

BRICK

You really think so? I was going for that, you know, man cave vibe, that real party feel. No boring shit you feel me? I want that nostalgic feel.

JERRY

Nostalgic?

BRICK

Yeah like those good old days when we could go do shit and not worry bout anything. You remember the junior year thing at uh... Raymond's place, you remember Raymond?

JERRY

I see him on Instagram sometimes-

BRICK

That crazy ass party, going for that
vibe completely. 24-7 non stop crazy
shit.

Jerry's brow furrows. He looks up, thinking.

JERRY

You mean the party where Mason's
older brother got caught doing coke
off of some Freshman's naked...
nevermind. I thought the police
showed up and everything?

BRICK

Oh. Well, not those parts, don't
really remember that too well, heh.

Jerry holds the object from his pocket in front of him, a
BADGE. Brick takes a swig.

BRICK

So, uh... God! Where are my manners,
shit I'm being a shitty host right
now. How you've been doing, what
brings you 'round the ole stomping
grounds.

JERRY

Oh it's fine, actually how I've been
is the reason I'm here.

BRICK

Not sure I understand, heh.

Jerry shows his badge to Brick

JERRY

I've been working for the city
police department.

BRICK

(far less energy)
Oh!..... Cool.

Brick stares towards the kitchen. Beyond Jerry, slightly
blurred: a tall glass bong, pill bottles scattered around,
white residue.

Jerry pockets his badge. Watches Brick. Follows his line
of sight to the bong.

JERRY

Oh no Brick. I'm criminal
investigations, like a detective.

BRICK
Ah, dope. Dope.

Brick takes another swig.

JERRY
Listen Brick, I'm not here for drugs or anything like that. I just need some info on someone you were seen with recently.

BRICK
Well, I don't hang around-I try not to hang around, you know, those type of people. I know I party hard man but that's not-

JERRY
Can I try asking? Can't hurt, right?

BRICK
Okay... I'm just a little hungover, so my mind, you know? I might not, uh-

JERRY
Well let's try. Dmitri Onglestov, ring any bells? Bald, european? He hangs out at clubs around town.

BRICK
Uhh, I think- yeah there was a guy like that, I'm not really-

JERRY
Where?

BRICK
My friend invited me to a club.

JERRY
Name of the friend?

BRICK
Ah, oh wait, I think-

Brick slaps his forehead.

BRICK
From school, what's her name. With the ass.

JERRY
Everyone at our school had an ass. Surely you remember her-

BRICK
Amanda. Amanda C.

JERRY
C?

BRICK
I don't remember her fuckin last
name man. You should be happy I
remembered the initial.

JERRY
That's alright Brick. Wait, Amanda
with the Brown scholarship?

BRICK
Oh yeah man. You should see her now.
When I saw her movin' in the club, I
couldn't believe.

JERRY
What club?

BRICK
2B.

JERRY
I'm sorry?

BRICK
2B, oh you haven't been, hah, just
what we call it, the Black Bazaar.

JERRY
Who's we?
(beat)

BRICK
Um, just Amanda. Yeah me and her got
real close you know?
(chuckles)

Jerry reaches back in his pocket.

BRICK
God you should see the way she's
grown-ooohwee.

JERRY
Anyone else.

BRICK
Nope just me and ma girl. Lemme tell
ya, she dances like a goddamn fox
dude. -Ay, don't get jealous but,
uh, your boy got to hit first so-

Jerry places a pile of photos on the coffee table. He fans them out like cards: Brick in the club with a scantily clad girl. Brick doing a beer bong. Security cam shot--Brick in a bathroom. A bald European man doing a line off of Brick's naked ass.

JERRY
You sure, no one else?

BRICK
-Ah fuck.

Brick holds onto his head.

JERRY
Brick, again, I'm not here for you,
I'm just asking for honest answers,
okay?

BRICK
Okay.

JERRY
How do you know Dmitri.

BRICK
Amanda.

JERRY
Amanda C?

BRICK
Yup.

JERRY
Did Amanda or anyone else give you a
contact or a number?

BRICK
You know what uhh-Hey wait what is
the guy in trouble for even, can't
just give away his number for
nothing, I didn't even know he-

JERRY
Kidnapping, possible homicide. Now:
contact, number, anything?

Brick stiffens up. His movements are now robotic. He sets down his beer.

BRICK
I have a card-he gave me a card.

JERRY
You have it?

BRICK
Actually, yeah. Let me get it,
it's-uh in the kitchen. You know
what? I need another beer anyway,
needa refill?

JERRY
I don't have a- I don't drink.

BRICK
How could I forget! Hahaha. Let me
get that for you.

JERRY
Yeah, no problem Brick. This is a
huge help to me.

Brick gets up and walks into the kitchen.

HOLD ON JERRY in the foreground, gathers the photos,
knocks over a couple of beer cans.

Behind him, Brick speed-walks to the fridge. Peeks inside.

Jerry bends over in his seat, picks up the cans.

Behind him, Brick glances over the fridge door - then
scurries down a hallway. Out of sight.

Empty kitchen behind, Jerry sits back up. Sets the cans on
the table. Slides the photos into his pocket.

Pauses.

One of the cans has condensation. Still cold. He picks it
up, shakes it - 3/4 full.

Jerry's eyes snap toward the empty kitchen.

He pops out of his seat. Gun already in hand.

3 THE KITCHEN

3

Jerry sweeps the room. Two hands on his pistol, raised.
One foot after the other.

His shoulder bumps the fridge door shut.

He takes cover at the hallway entrance.

4 THE HALLWAY

4

The hallway stretches ahead. At the end: a door that hangs
ajar. Light bleeds through the crack.

JERRY
Brick come out now!

No response.

Jerry swings around the corner, gun aimed straight ahead. He marches down the corner. The sound of furniture scraping the floor grows.

Jerry reaches the door, he peeks through the crack. He rams the door open with his shoulder.

5 BRICK'S BEDROOM

5

In front of Jerry, Brick stands on a crooked bed (Star Wars sheets), he hangs by the window sill, one foot lifted to the window.

JERRY

Brandin!

Brick turns to see the barrel of Jerry's gun. He falls down immediately onto the bed. He curls into fetal position.

BRICK

Ahhh! Don't shoot! Don't please! I wanna live, I wanna-

JERRY

Shut the fuck up Brick, I'm not gonna shoot you.

BRICK

Oh thank god-

Brick tries to sit up. Jerry aims his gun again.

JERRY

Get on your stomach Brick.

BRICK

Fuck alright! Shit dude!

Brick rolls over. Jerry lowers his gun and steps to the edge of the bed.

JERRY

What are you doing man? Is it really that bad?

Brick starts to whimper. A sniffle.

BRICK

I'm-I'm sorry Jerry, I don't- I wanted to- she said I could hook up with her!

JERRY

Amanda?

BRICK

Yes, yes... I can't, sniff, I can't believe she, I didn't know okay. I just wanted a crew to hang and those guys, you know, and the drugs and the girls and the-

JERRY

Dmitri?

BRICK

Y-Yes. I didn't know he was a criminal or anything, I swear dude. I didn't even- I was with Amanda most of the time anyways okay? I just talked with the guy and did drugs with him the one night.

JERRY

Yeah, I know.

BRICK

Listen I have it in my phone, I'll give you the number okay!?

Jerry takes handcuffs out from his back pocket.

JERRY

Damn right you are.

BRICK

Wait, wait-

JERRY

Don't worry I'm just taking you back to the station, after you give me the number I'll let you go.

BRICK

Phew, Ay thanks man. Thanks for looking out for me.

JERRY

...Yeah. No problem.

BRICK

It's good seein ya again dude.

JERRY

(defeated)

You too Brick.

Jerry cuffs Brick.

CUT TO:

6 EXT. BRICK'S APARTMENT - LATER**6**

Front door swings open to reveal Brick with both hand behind his back. Jerry follows close behind, keeping a loose grip on the handcuffs.

BRICK

Could you uh, can you lock the door.

JERRY

Yeah, you got the key?

BRICK

Should be in the ash tray by the door.

Jerry opens the door and leans inside. He reaches inside and leans back out with key in hand. He closes the door and locks it with his one free hand.

BRICK

Thanks.

CAMERA follows them as they make their way past several apartment doors, then DRIFTS AHEAD, leaving the two men behind.

CAMERA arrives at--

7 MRS. WANTER'S APARTMENT**7**

The window blinds are drawn but one hangs slightly tilted leaving a small gap, an eye can barely be seen peeking outside.

Jerry and Brick enter frame, crossing by the window. The ajar blind falls shut.

As the pass in front of the door, it bursts open to reveal a small elderly lady. This is MRS. WANTER.

MRS. WANTER

Brandin? I knew all that commotion was you.

Jerry and Brick stop. Brick stands on the left, Jerry on the right, his hand loosely gripping Brick's cuffed wrists. Mrs. Wanter between them in the doorway.

BRICK

Oh, 'sup Mrs. W.

MRS. WANTER

What... What's going on here Brandin, who is this man?

BRICK

Don't worry about me Mrs-

MRS. WANTER

Wait! Are you going to jail?! A little convenient to get arrested the day 'fore rent is due, isn't it Brandin?

JERRY

He should be home later today.

MRS. WANTER

Are you still going by Brick? You're 30 Brandin, why do you still want to act like a hooligan?

BRICK

-Yeah, sorry Mrs. Dub.

MRS. WANTER

Hmm.

(to Jerry)

Oh well you boys have fun. You make sure to have him home soon.

She waves-mainly at Jerry-then shuts the door.

JERRY

Fucking landlords man.

Brick shoots Jerry a smirk before they continue off screen.

8 EXT. PARKING LOT - DAY

8

Jerry guides Brick toward an unmarked sedan.

9 TITLE SEQUENCE - TBD

9

Montage as Jerry opens the door for Brick, who takes a seat in the back and they drive through city(TBD). Strip malls, Franchise restaurants. Bland apartment complexes. A downtown that peaked in the 1980s.

[specified city and filming locations tbd]

CUT TO:

10 EXT. POLICE STATION - PARKING LOT - DAY

10

11 ONE CONTINUOUS SHOT

11

Jerry's unmarked sedan pulls into a spot. The lot is half full - a mix of police cruisers, personal trucks, and EVs.

12 TITLE CARD: EARLIER THAT DAY**12**

THROUGH THE WINDSHIELD - Jerry. Eyes closed, taking deep breaths. Preparing himself.

Music swells, eyes open, he shakes it off.

Gets out, pops the trunk, grabs a black backpack.

Jerry walks through the parking lot, eyes mostly down.

Passes a neon green lifted truck - chrome everything. Windows tinted BLACK.

Jerry glances at it. Big exhale. Wipes his eyes.

Keeps walking.

Up the stairs.

Through the glass doors.

13 INT. POLICE STATION - CONTINUOUS**13**

Inside now. Fluorescent lights. Linoleum floors.

A RECEPTIONIST (late-30s) sits at the front desk, focused on her computer.

RECEPTIONIST
(not looking)
There's the early bird.

Jerry stops, musters a half-smile.

JERRY
Mornin'.

He taps the desk twice. Continues towards the hallway.

Jerry walks through the fluorescent light of the hallway. Past several doors with name placards he doesn't bother reading.

He enters the door marked: CRIMINAL INVESTIGATIONS DIVISION.

14 INT. CRIMINAL INVESTIGATIONS DIVISION - CONTINUOUS**14**

A cramped office. Five desks, three occupied. Heads down, typing, reading case files.

Jerry crosses to his desk near the back window, view of the parking lot. He drops his backpack on the floor.

He opens the drawer, pulls out a thick cream-colored folder, sets it on the desk.

Sits.

CAMERA DRIFTS away from Jerry, to a door across the office labeled: LT. GREENISH - CRIMINAL INVEST.

(pronounced greh-nihsh in this script)

The door opens. DETECTIVE STEVE WENTWORTH (40s, receding hairline), steps out. Coughs into his elbow, then totters toward the desks.

Stops before Jerry's desk. Jerry is reading a file while taking a sip from a Snoopy mug.

WENTWORTH
Lieutenant wants to see you.

JERRY
(distracted)
Morning Steve.

WENTWORTH
Greenish needs to talk to you.

JERRY
Yeah, uh, let me just get my stuff
settled I'll-

WENTWORTH
He said it was urgent.

JERRY
(deep sigh)
Alright man. Thanks.

Wentworth plops down at his desk, the one directly across from Jerry. As he sits down, Jerry gets up and drops the file back in the drawer, shutting it harder than necessary.

CUT TO:

15 INT. LT. GREENISH'S OFFICE

15

The door cracks open and Jerry peeks inside with his head.

JERRY
You need me boss?

LT. GREENISH
Come in Lefton.

Greenish sits at a big desk, fancier than the shitty one Jerry uses. A clunky monitor sits on his desk, behind him are framed pictures of himself, and various presidents as well as certificates relating to police school.

Jerry takes a seat, Greenish pushes a brown folder across the desk.

LT. GREENISH
How's your work coming along?

JERRY
Well, its coming I guess.

LT. GREENISH
Good, good. You know Jerry, you're one of our finest minds. Have I told you that before.

Jerry blinks. Scrunches his eyebrows.

JERRY
-Uh, well no sir but I mean- You might've told me, my memory sometimes you know-

LT. GREENISH
Well, you are, this is why I'm putting you in charge of a very important case.

JERRY
Ah.

LT. GREENISH
This is very important Jerry. And confidential. You are to work on this alone, okay?

JERRY
I'm sorry I'm not sure I understand.

Greenish taps the folder.

LT. GREENISH
Read up Lefton.

Jerry takes the folder and opens to the first document, CAMERA HOLDS ON Jerry as he reads.

LT. GREENISH (O.S.)
This one comes from upstairs, it's of highest priority you keep this to yourself.

As Jerry scans further down the page, he grows confused as Greenish's words don't seem to match what he's reading.

JERRY
Sir, it's says this is a missing
(MORE)

JERRY (CONT'D)
 persons case, possible homicide, I
 don't think one person-

LT. GREENISH
 Next page Lefton.

Jerry places the folder on the desk and turns to the next document. Greenish points with two fingers to a name on the page: MAYA LUPREEDY.

JERRY
 (under his breath)
 Lupreedy, I've heard that-
 (louder to Greenish)
 Wait, she isn't married to Mayor-

LT. GREENISH
 Keep it down trooper! What did I
 say, no one else is to work with you
 on this, those are your orders.

JERRY
 Sorry sir, I just- I'm working with
 Wentworth on that stolen goods-

LT. GREENISH
 I know and you know damn well
 Wentworth isn't doing shit behind
 that door. It's you and that's
 final. Also watch your language
 Lefton, show some respect to the
 badge!

JERRY
 Sorry sir.... Just if I could ask
 why me? You usually put me on
 smaller stuff- hell, I mean, heck
 it's been at least a year since
 working that missing boy case
 downtown.

Greenish sighs, crosses his arms, and leans back into his chair.

LT. GREENISH
 You get on my nerves sometimes
 Lefton- but it's why I like you, ya
 keep me honest. You know President
 Lincoln kept his rivals in his
 cabinet?

He flips to the next page. Hold on - Jerry as he reads, he traces his finger along the paper to keep his place.

JERRY
 ...I think I read about that in the-

Jerry reaches a word and stops, worry begins to flood his face.

LT. GREENISH

Moving on, you've lived here most of your life Jerry. We think you might have certain connections-

JERRY

Wait, wait, wait...
(reads a bit more)
These are people from my high school.

LT. GREENISH

Well yeah, I thought that was implied with Maya.

JERRY

Maya-Maya... Winston? Why is she married to the-

LT. GREENISH

Jerry listen, I just talked with the sarge, and the mayor... And a few other people but not important for you to know. We think you're the one for this. I need you to understand how urgent the situation is.

JERRY

I-

LT. GREENISH

It's you, you're our guy alright. Make us proud, we know you will.

Greenish stands, chest out, almost military, and motions towards the door. Jerry gets up, Greenish walks him to the door, opens it for him.

16 CRIMINAL INVESTIGATIONS DIVISION

16

Jerry walks out of Greenish's office, the door shuts quickly behind him.

Jerry walks back to his desk, a latina woman, similar age, sits in his chair. This is DETECTIVE RAMIREZ.

JERRY

Up.

RAMIREZ

Oh, hey Jerr. I need your help.

JERRY

I can see that, now up.

Ramirez stands up. She leans against the side of the desk, practically sitting on it.

RAMIREZ
What're you talking to Greenish about?

JERRY
Ah you know. Bullshit.

RAMIREZ
(sarcastic)
That's exactly what I need help with!

JERRY
Here just give me their name I'll have a report end of day.

Jerry sits down. He places the brown folder on the side of the desk not being sat on.

RAMIREZ
What's that?

JERRY
Case.

RAMIREZ
Wow. A case directly from Greenish. You suck his dick or something?

JERRY
Something like that... It's nothing, just another stolen goods situation.

RAMIREZ
Nevermind, he still fuckin hates you.
(chuckles)
Jerry stares at the brown folder. He leans back in his seat, eyes linger on the folder.

JERRY
You gotta name?

RAMIREZ
You're boring.... Jayson Smith DuPree.

Ramirez hands a sticky note to Jerry. He sticks it on the monitor in front of him. She gets up off the desk.

RAMIREZ
Well? You gonna search. I gotta real case going.

JERRY
-I got a case...

RAMIREZ
Yeah someone stole shampoo, big whoop. Listen, this fuck-
(points at the note)
Got caught with three girls, all minors, beat that!

JERRY
Jesus christ dude. Probably shouldn't brag about that.

RAMIREZ
(small chuckle)
Better see that report.

Ramirez gives Jerry a sly look, wags a finger at him playfully. Jerry's attention is still mostly on the brown folder. She walks back to her desk.

JERRY
Yeah, yeah.

Jerry grabs the folder and gets up from his chair.

17 **EXT. POLICE STATION - PARKING LOT - DAY** 17

Jerry sits in his sedan, reading the brown folder.

CAMERA DOLLIES into CU on Jerry through the windshield of his sedan.

CUT TO:

18 **INT. JERRY'S SEDAN** 18

ECU on the page Jerry is currently reading. We can see the name and picture of Brandin "Brick" Garrity.

CLOSE ON Jerry's face as his mouth falls agape.

JERRY
You gotta be fuckin kidding me.

CUT TO:

19 **INT. POLICE STATION - FRONT DESK - LATER** 19

Jerry is unlocking Brick's cuffs. Receptionist is still glued to the computer.

JERRY
Alright follow me.

Jerry turns to the narrow hallway but there stands Lt. Greenish.

LT. GREENISH
Mr. Garrity?

BRICK
Yeah.

LT. GREENISH
Come with me young man.

BRICK
Jerry, who's this G.I. Joe lookin mother-

JERRY
(quiet to Brick)
Just give him the number, he'll probably let you go.

BRICK
Probably? You don't sound too sure.

JERRY
Just do it.

Brick walks past Greenish into the hallway. Greenish smirks at Jerry.

LT. GREENISH
Solving the case and cleaning the streets at the same time. Doing good work Lefton, now back to it!

JERRY
Yeah-Yeah I got it.

Greenish retreats into the hall. Jerry turns to the receptionist who's still locked on her screen.

JERRY
What game is it today? Crossword or Pinball.

RECEPTIONIST
I thought Greenish just said get back to work.

JERRY
Yes he did...

RECEPTIONIST
Crossword.

Jerry exhales through his nose. He grins.

20 EXT. SEDAN - EVENING**20**

Jerry closes the brown case file in his lap, tosses it aside.

He closes his eyes. Takes a breath. Shakes it off.

He steps out of his sedan into--

21 EXT. AMANDA'S APARTMENT**21**

Badge in hand, he knocks on the door.

The shuffling of footsteps before the door cracks open.

Peeking through is a brown haired woman (30s) wearing a small tank top and OSCAR THE GROUCH pajama bottoms. This is MARY JOSEPH.

MARY
(rubbing her eyes)
Can I help you?

JERRY
Hi Miss, I'm Detective Jerry Lefton
I was just wondering if Amanda was
home?

MARY
No.

JERRY
Oh.... Do you think she'll be back
here tomorrow?

MARY
Maybe?

JERRY
Okay I'll be back tomorrow.

Jerry turns to leave.

MARY
Wait-

Jerry stops.

MARY
Is this about Maya? Are you
investigating-

JERRY
Yes.

MARY
Can I ask-

JERRY
I'll be back tomorrow.

Jerry walks off. Mary leans in the door frame, dejected.

CUT TO:

22 EXT. AMANDA'S APARTMENT - NEXT MORNING

22

Jerry steps up to the door. He knocks.

Mary opens the door, same clothes. Messier hair.

MARY
Jesus christ, what time is it?

JERRY
Amanda back yet?

MARY
You think she's back?

JERRY
Like I said: I'm back to check if
Amanda-

MARY
I know that, it's just- it hasn't
even been, what? Ten hours?

JERRY
Well I didn't have anything else on
my checklist today so, this is the
first thing I'm doing, like I said.

MARY
You know what I think you're doing
detective?

JERRY
I'm sorry?

MARY
You came back early, knowing Amanda
wasn't going to be here. Cross
another item off your checklist
before closing this "missing person"
case. Fuck off

JERRY
I just- listen I'm sorry if it seems
like I'm not doing my job, but trust
me I'm doing my best to find Maya.

MARY
Oh really?

JERRY

How about I come back later tonight,
if she isn't here maybe you could
answer a few questions for me?

MARY

Like hell I'm gonna tell you-

Jerry puts his hands up.

JERRY

Or not! I just- I'm assuming you
were a friend of Maya's? Am I
correct?

Mary nods.

JERRY

Okay. Well then. If you have any
information that could be of use,
I'll be back tonight. Okay?

MARY

Okay.

Jerry sighs, then walks away, head down. Mary leans on the
door frame, smirk on her face.

CUT TO:

23 INT. SECURITY ROOM - BLACK BAZAAR

23

Ramirez leans in a door frame, same position as Mary. She
has a less than pleased look.

She's listening to two men off screen arguing.

JERRY (O.S.)

Just-just go back right there...
yes! -no, no, no. Not there I said-

YOUNG MAN (O.S.)

I don't... can you just give me some
space man? It's not that easy as it-

Her view widens to reveal the subject of Ramirez's
attention: Jerry hunched over a small computer and a young
man (early 20s) fiddling with the controls.

They are watching security camera footage on a small
monitor.

JERRY

Yes! Right there! Ramirez, I need an
opinion.

Ramirez pushes herself off the door frame. She stands to the side of the desk.

JERRY
No! Why'd you move it?

YOUNG MAN
I'm sorry I thought you wanted-

JERRY
Did I say anything?

YOUNG MAN
Man, I didn't- maybe I should just get my boss.

JERRY
Just let me- get out of the way.

YOUNG MAN
That's not how it works, you need like a warrant I'm pretty sure.

JERRY
Up.

Jerry motions for the young man to get up. The young man scowls back at Jerry. He stands.

RAMIREZ
(to young man)
Sorry about that. He can be a little ya know... just sometimes.

YOUNG MAN
Whatever, I'm outta here, just don't break anything or my boss is gonna kick my ass.

RAMIREZ
Roger that.

He steps out, door still ajar. Jerry is already deeply focused on the screen. He's leaned forward, eyes almost touching the monitor.

JERRY
See it's right here. I don't see why that kid couldn't just- I mean I barely know how computers work and I can still figure out a scroll wheel-

RAMIREZ
What'd you find?

JERRY
Right, sorry.

Jerry leans a bit back. Still forward in his chair.

JERRY

Right here.

Jerry hits the space bar, the video starts playing. Dmitri talks with Maya in an alleyway at night.

RAMIREZ

Yeah, looks like the photo you showed me.

JERRY

Watch the end.

The video ends with Dmitri passing a card to Maya. Maya walks off in one direction, out of view. Dmitri stays to talk on his phone.

JERRY

Then he's like this for 3 minutes.

Jerry clicks slightly further on the video scroll bar. Dmitri get's off of his phone, then walks back through a door into the club.

JERRY

It has to be him.

RAMIREZ

I guess? Maybe he does it off camera, I don't have enough to be sure. You've barely told my anything about this case.

JERRY

It's fine. This should be pretty clear cut. Now I just need to upload this...

RAMIREZ

Uhn-huh.

Ramirez crosses her arms. Jerry leans forward. Focus back on the screen.

RAMIREZ

I don't know Jerry, from the point of this video, all I see is a man handing a girl a card then going about his business. Go further into the footage.

JERRY

Ramirez I think you should stay out of this, I've got it figured now.

RAMIREZ
Look asshole!

Ramirez takes hold of the mouse. She clicks forward.

Dmitri stands on his phone. Then goes back inside.

RAMIREZ
Now switch to the inside camera. See
if he leaves.

Jerry looks at Ramirez with wide eyes. Trying to hide a grin.

Jerry clicks to another cam, further in the video: Dmitri is dancing sloppily with Brick, time stamp reads: 3:23:54 AM.

RAMIREZ
So this guy doesn't leave the entire
night.

Jerry clicks some more.

JERRY
Looks like it.

RAMIREZ
And we have- sorry, you have no clue
where this girl goes after this
video.

JERRY
No.

RAMIREZ
And you're saying he got her killed?

JERRY
That's a big jump. Kidnapped,
probably.

RAMIREZ
Holy... All I can do is guess Jerry.
I know jack shit about this case, I
can't- just-
(collects herself)
What I don't get: To me, it looks
like he gives her a card then makes
a call then goes back inside the
rest of the night. I know for a fact
he wasn't the one to actually do it.
Sure he might be implicated but we
don't know that.

JERRY
You don't know that.

RAMIREZ

You don't know that. Dick.

JERRY

It's just, you see what I'm saying.
He's all we got so far.

RAMIREZ

All you got.

In the other room, the young man is talking with an older gentleman dressed in a polo at a bar. They both look over at the room.

RAMIREZ

Let's just go before you harass the employees any more.

JERRY

....Fine.

CUT TO:

24 EXT. JERRY'S SEDAN - BLACK BAZAAR PARKING LOT - LATER

24

Jerry and Ramirez are sitting inside Jerry's sedan.
Ramirez holds the brown case file in front of her.

RAMIREZ

I still can't figure out why
Greenish put you on such an
important case.

(joking)

Must feel nice huh? Special
treatment.

Jerry is struggling with his seatbelt, its caught.

RAMIREZ

Greenish promise something special
if you solve it? A raise? A blow-

JERRY

He just said he wanted me alone on
it, is all. Confidentiality.

RAMIREZ

That's not it, you'd die before
brown nosing that jarhead.

Jerry finally gets his seatbelt buckled. Ramirez sets the folder down.

RAMIREZ

That old piece of shit's gone senile
on us.

Ramirez and Jerry stare at each other for a beat, serious. Before they can't hold back a small bit of laughter.

Jerry starts the car.

JERRY

Thanks for coming by the way.

RAMIREZ

Explain to me why you needed me for some security tapes.

JERRY

Uh well, the club owner's a prick to start. I mean it's why we only had pictures when he clearly has the tapes. Although it's obvious now they probably didn't have the bright minds to work a computer.

RAMIREZ

Okay? Still not sure why you dragged me along.

JERRY

You're better with people. You think that old guy lets us in if I don't bring a young woman-

RAMIREZ

(teasing)

Ooh, young woman, eh?

JERRY

(smiling)

Fuck off. Just, you're better with people usually with these things so-so I guess I'm just saying-

RAMIREZ

Nah, it's fine. Don't mention it. Better than whatever the fuck I'm doing back at the station.

JERRY

Thanks.

Ramirez looks out the window. Jerry drives off.

25 **EXT. JERRY'S SEDAN - STATION PARKING LOT - AFTERNOON**

25

Jerry's car pulls up to the curb of the station.

Ramirez pops her door open.

RAMIREZ
You sure you don't need anything
from your desk?

JERRY
I'm good, I packed everything for-

RAMIREZ
Alright, I get the idea.

Ramirez steps out. Peeks back in.

RAMIREZ
Good luck. Hope you find your girl.

JERRY
(distant)
Yeah. Thanks.

RAMIREZ
See ya tomorrow.

Ramirez chuckles. She pushes the door close.

Jerry accelerates before the door fully closes.

Ramirez stares at the car as Jerry drives off.

26 EXT. JERRY'S APARTMENT - PARKING LOT - AFTERNOON 26

Jerry pulls into a spot marked 303.

He gets out. Pops the trunk. Takes his backpack out.

27 INT. JERRY'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS 27

The door unlocks. Jerry steps inside, wipes his feet on a clean welcome mat. No text. Gray.

Flicks on his lights. Three light switches. Then turns off one of them.

The shades are drawn.

Jerry walks into the kitchen. He turns on a coffee maker.

He walks over to the couch, drops his bag.

He plops down. Wipes his face with his hands.

Something on the far wall catches his attention.

He gets up, crosses the room. A whiteboard--covered in notes about a stolen game console.

He grabs an eraser clears the board. Several plain black magnets sit in the corner.

Jerry walks back to the couch and opens his backpack.

He grabs the BROWN CASE FILE.

Walks back over to the whiteboard. Attaches the headshot of Maya in the center.

He grabs a blue marker draws a circle around her. Then a line to another circle. He attaches the security cam photo of Dmitri.

DISSOLVE TO:

28 LATER

28

The light through the shades has slightly dimmed.

The whiteboard: now filled with photos and blue line connections, frantic notes. Maya's photo still at the center.

Jerry stands a foot away. Staring.

He looks down at his notebook, which he holds in front of his chest. A list of several locations.

He pockets the notebook. Turns around.

On a coffee table case files are scattered about. Jerry struggles to organize them.

He does, then slides them back into the brown case file. Then into his backpack. He zips it up.

CUT TO:

29 INT. SILVER DOLLAR DINER - AFTERNOON

29

An empty diner. A WAITRESS (aged 50s) wipes a counter.

Bells jingle as the door opens. Jerry enters. He wipes his feet down on a door mat.

DISSOLVE TO:

30 LATER

30

WAITRESS

-they were a rowdy group of kids,
but never caused any kinda trouble.

The waitress holds a photo of Amanda. Jerry sits at the counter.

JERRY

So you're sure you never saw her
with anyone other than those kids?

WAITRESS

Never.

JERRY

Okay, well thanks for your time
maam.

WAITRESS

You sure I can't get anything for ya
honey? Coffee's on the house for a
city detective.

Jerry tries to hold back a smile.

JERRY

No thank you.

WAITRESS

Well good luck then, hope you find
that girl.

Jerry takes the photo back. He swivels off his seat. Walks
down the diner,

DISSOLVE TO:

31 INT. CATHY'S CAF - AFTERNOON

31

Jerry is sitting back in a blue bean bag.

VOICE (O.S.)

-pretty rad bunch I'd say.

Across, a BARISTA (male, 20s), in a red bean bag. In
between them a small circle coffee table.

JERRY

Same group every time?

BARISTA

I don't know dude. I see them
sometimes, but I only work on
Monday, Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday.
You know, so I don't see them that
often.

JERRY

Well how often would you say you've
seen them.

BARISTA

Fair bit actually--now that I think
about it.

JERRY

Okay?

BARISTA

Yeah was just them for the most part but, I don't know maybe they'd be hanging out with some boys. But no baldies, I'd deffo remember if they got a bald boy.

JERRY

...You sure I can't talk to Cathy.

Both turn to look over their shoulders. A long line. Behind the counter, high school and college aged kids frantically manning machines, working the cash register.

A small lady wearing a neon purple apron, stitched on lettering: CATHY.

CATHY (O.S.)

-You're going to burn the- just let me do it! Move!

The barista turns back to Jerry.

BARISTA

Probably not dude.

JERRY

Yeah I see that. I'll leave you to it then, thanks for your help.

Jerry lumbers up from the bean bag. He walks out the door.

Through the window, past a sign for the caf - Jerry walks out and around the corner.

CUT TO:

32 EXT. AMANDA'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

32

Jerry speed-walks around a corner to Amanda's building.

Slows at the entrance. He glances at some freshly planted flowers lining the walkway entrance. Marigolds.

Jerry goes to knock. The door opens.

MARY

'Sup detective man.

This time, Mary is wearing a striped sweatshirt. And baggy jeans.

JERRY

Good evening.

Jerry's worked up a small sweat.

MARY
Wanna come in? Or is this a take me
to the holding cell kind of deal.

JERRY
No, uh- is Amanda not here?

MARY
Of course not. So you wanna come in
or no?

JERRY
Yeah. Okay, thanks.

33 INT. AMANDA'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

33

Jerry steps inside. Mary makes her way to the kitchen.

Jerry goes to wipe his feet. There is no welcome mat.

MARY (O.S.)
Do you mind taking your shoes off? I
like to keep dirt off our floors.

Jerry looks down. There is dirt all over the floor.

Jerry kicks his shoes off onto a pile of flip-flops and
converse.

MARY (O.S.)
Whaddya drink detective?

JERRY
I don't.

MARY
On the job, I get it. Water?

JERRY
Yes please.

Mary pulls two glasses from a cupboard, a Brita from her
fridge.

She walks into the living area. There are two couches
arranged in an L shape, across from a small TV.

Mary hands Jerry a glass.

MARY
Have a seat.

Jerry takes a seat on the far side of one couch. Mary sits
on the close side of the other.

JERRY
So, is Amanda out often?

Mary is mid sip.

MARY

-Oh, guess we go right into it then.
Uh-yeah this is pretty typical of
her. Especially when she finds new
people to party with.

JERRY

You know these "new people"?

MARY

No, well I met one of them. But just
once when she decided to-

JERRY

What did they look like?

Jerry clicks a pen. Turns a page in his notebook.

MARY

White, tall--six footish, curly
brown hair?

JERRY

You get his name?

MARY

No I just said hi to the guy in
passing really.

JERRY

Okay... Does Amanda tell you where
she's going?

MARY

Not usually, not this time. But she
always shows up eventually. I've
learned not to ask, saves me a lot
of bitching.

JERRY

Does Amanda have anywhere she likes
to hangout? Restaurants, bars,
secret bunkers?

MARY

Secret bunkers...

JERRY

Sorry just an example.

MARY

It's a bad example.

Jerry looks down. He sits forward.

MARY

Did you try the Silver Dollar diner
down on-

JERRY

Yup.

MARY

...Okay. We would meet a cafe
nearby. I forget what it's called.

JERRY

Cathy's Corner-

MARY

Cathy's Corner Coffee! Did you check
there?

JERRY

...Yes.

Jerry shows Mary his notebook: locations with all the
names crossed out.

MARY

There is one place--I shouldn't
though.

JERRY

You shouldn't? The only things I
know are in a thin brown case
folder. Any secret spot, anything
that only a friend would know.

Mary scrunches her face, then relaxes:

MARY

There is this one place where we
would hang out a ton with our old
friend group.

JERRY

Your old friend group?

MARY

Yeah it's how we became roommates..
They still go there I'm pretty sure.
Though I stopped hanging out with
that crowd

JERRY

Why? Drugs?

MARY

Drama.

JERRY

Ah. Where is this place?

MARY

Ummm.

Jerry leans back again.

MARY

It's a real hole in the wall, I'll say. Might not even be on a map. It's literally run out of an apartment. But the cook there, he's really chill, he runs the place. I've always liked him.

JERRY

Well, that's great, do you have the address?

MARY

See, the thing is, this is kinda a sacred spot for some people. At least the people who I've seen go there. I'm not going to take away this safe space, because it got written in some police report.

JERRY

Are you kidding me.

MARY

Well you wouldn't understand, you're a cop.

JERRY

What's that got to do... What happened to saving Maya?

MARY

(perking up)

Oh shit this really is the Maya case?

JERRY

Yes! Did you not--what about the other night?

MARY

I was joking. I thought the mayor was trying to cover up her disappearance just before the election.

JERRY

You should get off of social media.

MARY
Is it not true?

JERRY
No! I'm working on it...

MARY
And? Just you?

JERRY
Uh... Bosses orders.

MARY
So you just lick the boot then?

JERRY
You're pretty rude, you know that.

Jerry leans back forward. Mary takes a sip of water, amused.

JERRY
Just tell me, is this even a place worth investigating, why mention it at all?

MARY
Well, if Amanda isn't there, our group might be. At the least, one person there will know Amanda well. She goes there a ton. That's what she tells me when she's home.

JERRY
For sure, someone will know her?

MARY
Yeah the cook.

JERRY
Okay, then write down the directions for me.

MARY
Can't do that copper. Take me with you.

JERRY
I can't do that.

MARY
I'm a great passenger princess, trust me I give great directions.

Mary stands up. Begins to tie her hair up.

JERRY

No, that breaks probably a lot of rules or codes or-

MARY

You're not finding a way there without me. Plus they won't even let you inside without me.

JERRY

I gotta badge, surely they-

MARY

No go copper. They don't like cops over there. Very liberal crowd.

Mary stretches her arms. Walks over to the door.

JERRY

Right now?

MARY

Yeah, it's Tuesday night they'll for sure be there.

JERRY

Alright but you do exactly-

MARY (O.S.)

Hey! What's with all the dirt?!

Jerry stands slowly, sees the dirt he tracked in.

JERRY

Sorry about that.

MARY

I'll clean it when we get back.

Mary grabs his shoes and places them outside.

Jerry stares, arms crossed. Really?

34 EXT. AMANDA'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

34

Jerry steps out in his socks. He jams his feet into his shoes. Loses balance on the second one. He slips, stumbles-

MARY

Hey watch the flowers, I just planted those.

JERRY

...Let's go.

Mary and Jerry walk around the corner out of sight.

35 **EXT. COOK'S APARTMENT COMPLEX - PARKING LOT - EVENING**

35

An empty lot.

Jerry's sedan pulls in. Parks crooked, far walking distance from the curb.

JERRY
402 you said? Alright, I won't take long.

He unbuckles.

MARY
He isn't going to talk to you

JERRY
I gotta badge.

MARY
He won't care. He's not like you, he's chill.

JERRY
Just stay

Jerry opens his door, steps out. As he shuts his door: Mary's opens.

JERRY
(under his breath)
The fuck did I just--fuckit, like I care.

MARY
C'mon ya grouchy.

Mary gets out and skips past a grouchy Jerry.

36 **INT. COOK'S APARTMENT COMPLEX - HALLWAY**

36

MARY
Just, stand back for a bit okay?

Mary and Jerry stand in front of a door labelled: 402.

She knocks 5 times in a pattern.

A beat.

From behind the door:

COOK (O.S.)
Mary is that you?

The door swings open to reveal THE COOK (late 60s).

He wears a dirty white apron and a bushy white Santa Claus beard.

COOK
My-my Mary. Our marigold has come
home huh.
(chuckles)
How long it must-

The cook leans forward into the door frame. Jerry comes into the cook's view.

COOK
Who is- Mary who is this? Couldn't
be little Ethan right?

Jerry spins around. The cook scans him up and down.

MARY
He's... Just my ride. He's not
important-

Jerry is displeased at this comment.

MARY
Could we talk in private?

JERRY
-Hold on now.

COOK
You wanna wait here for a little
bit?

MARY
He can wait in the car.
(to Jerry)
Can you wait in the-

JERRY
What the fuck- you're not even
supposed to be here! How about you
wait?

COOK
Now you dont talk to her-

Jerry holds his badge out in front of him. Flashes it.

JERRY
I'm Detective Jerry Lefton with the
city-

COOK
Hold on now, Mary who is this? Why
did you bring this man here?

MARY

No it's okay I promise just let me-
 (to Jerry)
 Just shut the fuck up okay? Please?

COOK

(distraught)
 How could you bring this cop here
 Mary? I haven't even seen you in
 months!

Behind the three of them, a door marked 401 swings open.

In the door way stands an old lady.

OLD LADY

Will you people be quiet? It's my
 bedtime Norman you know that!

COOK

Sorry Renee, these two were just-

OLD LADY

Don't make me call the landlord!

The old lady huffs and slams the door shut.

The cook lets out a heavy sigh.

COOK

It was nice seeing you again Mary,
 but maybe not on these terms.
 (to Jerry)
 Now if you two would leave.

JERRY

Fucking waste of my- let's go.

Jerry turns to leave.

MARY

Please, it's about Maya. And Amanda.

Amanda's name catches the cook's attention.

COOK

...Is Amanda okay?

MARY

That's why we're here.

The cook looks Jerry up and down one more time.

COOK

Alright, come in. But! No talking
 with anyone inside. Talking to the
 pig.

MARY
(chuckles)
I know.

They both look at Jerry.

JERRY
Let's go.

37 INT. COOK'S APARTMENT - CONTINUOUS

37

The cook leads them into the apartment.

A small abode, set up with a few folding tables, with folding chairs.

A haze in the air. Maybe food. Maybe pot.

At one of the tables, a group of 4 young adults (college age). Dressed in different black alt and gothic clothes. Dyed hair and piercings.

They all peek a look over at the new visitors.

The cook stops at a corner table, far from the others.

COOK
Let's sit here.

Jerry and Mary join him.

COOK
Amanda was here last week, you know.
We had a nice conversation about
women's volleyball. But, uh, that
group there Mary, she's still with
'em.

MARY
I know.

COOK
Some characters.

Jerry grabs his notebook in his pocket. It gets stuck, trying to get it out.

Jerry tries to hide the fact he is struggling with his jacket:

JERRY
Yeah great times, love those guys.

COOK
Oh, really? You know-

JERRY

No! Of course not. Let's stop with the inside jokes. I have no fucking clue what you people are talking about.

MARY

Jesus Christ dude. Calm down.

COOK

Need something? I got tea, coffee-

Jerry finally gets his notebook out. Clicks his pen.

JERRY

Talk more about this group.

COOK

...okay then. A bit after Mary here left, your little group, started getting, not-so-little. I vetted them of course but, I don't know. Amanda just seemed out of it the last few times we've talked.

JERRY

Define: out of it.

COOK

Well, of course they started coming over less, although I don't mind that. But the stuff I hear them talking about. Their adventures have gotten a little adventurous let's just say-

JERRY

Define: adventurous.

COOK

When I first met them, when I first met Mary, they loved the calm and peace of this place. The restaurants and bars they talked about going to were all quaint, hole in the wall type of place. But now- I don't know, I shouldn't judge.

Jerry tosses his notebook on the table. And the pen.

JERRY

Okay let's try this: you finish your thought, we get out.

COOK

Oh, why should I tell you anything. They're good kids!

JERRY
They could be the Beatles for all I
care. You protecting them right now,
is directly getting in the way of me
finding Maya.

Cook leans back. Somber look as he stars at Jerry.

COOK
You know Maya?

JERRY
No.

COOK
Hmmm.

Crosses his arms

COOK
You're really looking for Mary?

JERRY
Yes.

COOK
And you're with the city police-

JERRY
(exasperated)
Yes.

A beat.

COOK
...They would talk about their
outings at these fancy clubs
recently. They've been hanging out
with people from these places, even
asked if they could come here.

MARY
You let 'em?

COOK
Hell no, these aren't good people.

JERRY
What do mean? How would you know?

COOK
Like I said: I vet everyone who
wants shelter here.

JERRY
Shelter from what?

COOK
The world.

JERRY
What was so bad about these people?

COOK
Rich. Corrupt. Old money trust fund kids.

JERRY
Having a lot of money doesn't make you a bad person.

COOK
I'd argue not, but I ain't arguing with a pig.

JERRY
Could you stop saying that?

The cook smiles at Jerry. Mary smiles at the cook.

COOK
These are people with ties to government figures. They can't get in trouble. These spoiled brats have never experienced consequence. It's a foreign concept to them.

JERRY
But-

COOK
In fact, last time that group was here, they were talking about all the coke they were able to snort for free at a mansion party. They talked about this crazy European man.

JERRY
They say his name?

COOK
Ah no, just mentioned he had a funny accent. Said he was the hardest partier they've seen.

JERRY
They mention anything about him being bald?

COOK
Now that you say... I think they did.

Jerry perks up in his seat. He scribbles something down in his notebook.

JERRY
You said something about government ties, are you talking about the Mayor.

COOK
Lupreedy? That bastard. Wouldn't be surprised if he did Maya in himself...

Jerry looks down at his lap, at his notebook. He scans down the page with his eyes.

He smiles. Stands.

JERRY
Thank you Norman. All of this is has been extremely helpful.

MARY
That's it?

JERRY
That's it. Let's go.

Mary looks at the cook.

COOK
Oh it's okay, it was very nice to see you Mary. Please come back sometime, okay?

MARY
Of course I will.

She stands.

MARY
Thank you so much. I'm so sorry about-

COOK
Don't mention it girl.

Jerry stands by the door. He's wiping his feet on the welcome mat.

JERRY (O.S.)
C'mon let's go.

Mary smiles at the cook before taking off with Jerry.

38 EXT. COOK'S APARTMENT COMPLEX - PARKING LOT - NIGHT

38

Jerry is marching confidently across the lot to his sedan.

Mary lags behind walking, arms crossed.

MARY

You're a real dick, you know that?

Jerry stops. Spins around.

JERRY

I'm sorry?

MARY

Why'd you have to be such an asshole to him? He's just a sweet old-

JERRY

Why's that old creep got kids at his place?

MARY

Hey! You can't call him a creep. You don't know him.

JERRY

That's not weird? It's not creepy like at all?

Jerry and Mary are now yelling at each other across the parking lot.

MARY

He's a nice man.

JERRY

Nice? He called me a pig.

MARY

Well...

JERRY

Like you said: he doesn't know me. You don't know me. Where does he get off calling me- I'm trying to save a missing person here!

MARY

You call this trying? One man going door to door, like a knife salesman? What the fuck kinda operation-

VOICE (O.S.)

Uh, excuse me?

Mary turns, Jerry leans to see past her. One of the girls from the apartment.

ALT GIRL
You guys were asking about Maya
right? You're trying to find her?

JERRY
Uhh...

MARY
Yes. Well he is. He's a detective.

Jerry waves over to her.

ALT GIRL
I might know where she was last
seen.

JERRY
The Black Bazaar?

ALT GIRL
No. Somewhere else.

JERRY
Let's talk in the car.

CUT TO:

39 JERRY'S SEDAN

39

Jerry sits up front with alt girl. Mary sits in the back middle seat.

Jerry has his pen and notebook out.

ALT GIRL
-last time she texted me, it lines
up with her disappearing.

JERRY
Just to double check, this is the
address right?

Jerry shows her the notebook. In big lettering:

17 SOUTH ALAMEDA AVE.

ALT GIRL
Yeah.

MARY
My god, it's just- what could've
happened there?

ALT GIRL

I was talking about it with some of Amanda's friends. They think drugs, or she eloped, it could be a lot of things.

MARY

She doesn't- it doesn't sound liker her to go party with some douche.

JERRY

And no mention of any bald people there?

ALT GIRL

...Uh, I don't think we really talked about the hairstyles of other people. I guess.

JERRY

(tired)

Ah, well thanks this is a ton of help.

ALT GIRL

Please find her. She was a very kind soul.

MARY

We will, don't worry.

The alt girl gets out the car, closes the door.

Mary clumsily climbs into the passenger seat. Accidentally, hits Jerry in the side of his head with her shoe.

JERRY

Ow! Fuck.

MARY

Stop being so dramatic.

She readjusts and buckles her seatbelt.

JERRY

Weird fucking group going on here.

MARY

Whatever just drive.

Jerry's starting to break a little.

JERRY

No, honestly, I want to know. Of all places, some dudes dank-ass
(MORE)

JERRY (CONT'D)

apartment. I mean, I don't like clubs or bars either but damn. Would rather stay home than hang with some bum.

MARY

You wouldn't- Listen there are some people in the world who have known nothing but rejection and exclusion and prejudice for reasons completely out of their control. See I can believe you being lonely because you're a miserable fuck, but some people are lonely because the world is cruel.

JERRY

Yeah I bet that old white man suffered a LOT of prejudice.

Jerry chuckles to himself starting the car. Mary snaps:

MARY

Don't you ever-
(slapping the dash)
That man was drafter to 'Nam, he was gay living in the south. He doesn't have friends from there. He doesn't have family. You don't understand, you will never understand. So just shut up and do your fucking job!

A beat.

Silence. The low rumble of the car. I wasn't-

Jerry stares at his shoes for a second.

JERRY

(softly)
I'm sorry I'm getting so worked up it's just- All I want is to find this girl, it's the first real case I've ever had in 2 years of service. I just want to find her, and when people get in the way of that by--being people--it's crushing. Like I can hear the minutes- the seconds of her life ticking away in the back of my head.

Mary looks more softly at Jerry now.

JERRY

I know I didn't know this girl okay,
(MORE)

JERRY (CONT'D)
 especially like you did. But the
 burden of her life, of bringing
 someone back from the dead is on me.
 And I'll be damned before I let that
 happen.

MARY
 It... wasn't right for your boss to
 put this entire case on you.

JERRY
 I know. Doesn't change the fact it
 still is all on me... Sorry about my
 behavior. Would you, uh, tell him
 I'm sorry next time you see him?

MARY
 Sure.

JERRY
 Thanks.

Jerry releases the hand brake. His sedan pulls out of the
 lot.

Mary is softly smiling, looking out the window.

DISSOLVE TO:

40 **EXT. MARY'S APARTMENT - PARKING LOT - NIGHT**

40

Jerry's sedan pulls up to the curb.

He gets out, goes to open Mary's door. She opens it before
 he can.

Mary steps out. Starts to walk off.

JERRY
 Night.

Without turning:

MARY
 I'm sorry too.

JERRY
 What?

She spins around.

MARY
 I said I'm sorry, I was being mean
 earlier.

He cracks a smirk. The happiest Jerry's been so far.

JERRY
You're good.

MARY
And thank you--for looking for
her--I didn't think anyone was.

He nods.

Mary turns back around walks off.

41 MONTAGE - JERRY DRIVES HOME - NIGHT

41

Cachet du Vois - "If Only" (melancholic Rnb) plays
throughout.

A) EXT. MARY'S APARTMENT - Jerry leans on the hood of his
car. Watches Mary until she turns a corner out of his
sight. He pushes himself up, walks around to the driver
side.

B) EXT. CITY STREETS - Jerry's sedan cruises through town.

C) EXT. PARK - The sedan passes. Some teenagers loitering.

D) EXT. POLICE STATION - The sedan passes. Only light
still on is LT. GREENISH's office.

E) EXT. JERRY'S APARTMENT COMPLEX - The sedan pulls into
parking spot 303

END MONTAGE.

42 INT. JERRY'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

42

Door unlocks, Jerry walks inside.

Flicks light switches on. Turns one of them back off.

Drops his backpack by the door. Locks it.

Walks into the kitchen, Jerry's full apartment comes into
view for the first time.

Minimalist. Only the essentials. A couch. A table.

Kitchen counter has a toaster and a cheap Keurig.

Walls bare.

Only thing hanging is the whiteboard in the living room.

Jerry walks out of the kitchen Garfield mug in hand.

Sits down, takes a sip. Grimaces.

Sets the mug down. The table stained with water rings.

Stares across the room. At the whiteboard.

At the center of his attention: MAYA. Her picture sits in the middle of a web of scribbles and news clips.

He jumps out of his seat. Grabs his keys and backpack.

Leaves. Locks the door.

Coffee still on the table steaming.

CUT TO:

43 INT. SILVER DOLLAR DINER - LATER

43

Jerry stares into a half-full mug of cold coffee. His notepad beside it, covered in cramped scribbles.

YOUNG WAITRESS (O.S.)
-Amanda's a total bitch, yeah.

Jerry looks up. The YOUNG WAITRESS (young 20s, energetic) leans over the counter.

YOUNG WAITRESS
That whole gang's weird. Strange.

JERRY
Any guys ever with them?

YOUNG WAITRESS
Oh yeah. There's this gay dude- or maybe non-binary? I think he wore a dress, I mean she-

JERRY
Let's stick to what you saw.
(reading notes)
You said more recently-

YOUNG WAITRESS
-more recently, they've been bringing these total creeps... It's horrible for business you know? Scares the customers-

JERRY
What did they look like?

YOUNG WAITRESS
Total losers. Greasy hair, tight pants-

JERRY
Tight?

She holds her fingers a centimeter apart. Jerry stares at the space.

An uncomfortable beat.

JERRY
Whattya mean losers?

YOUNG WAITRESS
Like, dealers or something. Always bragging about money and connections.

JERRY
Connection to what?

YOUNG WAITRESS
Best places to score, party. Like I give a fuck where these guys swing their-

JERRY
What places? Where?

YOUNG WAITRESS
A club. A bizarre black something.

Jerry flips to a page in his notepad.

Circles something for the waitress.

YOUNG WAITRESS
The Black Bazaar, ugh! Total sleaze fest.

JERRY
You sure?

YOUNG WAITRESS
Yeah, been once. Smelled like dick-

Jerry slides a ten across the counter, already standing.

YOUNG WAITRESS
That's it? I got way more dirt on that skank-

JERRY
Appreciate your help.

YOUNG WAITRESS
(calling after him)
Amanda stiffed me on a check once!
It was over fifty dollars!

But Jerry's gone. She pockets the cash, dumps the old coffee.

44 EXT. SILVER DOLLAR DINER - NIGHT**44**

Jerry exits out the glass doors.

He pauses.

Looks both ways. Takes off right.

DISSOLVE TO:

45 EXT. BLACK BAZAAR - NIGHT**45**

Jerry's sedan cruises down an industrial strip. Warehouses, abandoned stores. A purple glow washes over the car.

46 INT. JERRY'S SEDAN - CONTINUOUS**46**

Jerry stares at his notepad, held inches from his face. Circled four times: BLACK BAZAAR.

He's stopped, squinting at a building. In front of him: a PACKED parking lot. Luxury cars, limos.

A purple vested valet takes keys from an elderly man hobbling out of a purple Mercedes.

JERRY

Jesus.

47 EXT. BLACK BAZAAR - PARKING LOT - CONTINUOUS**47**

Jerry pulls into a spot, in between a yellow Lambo and a blacked out Range Rover.

Gets out. Nervously adjusts his tie.

The building: a black cube. No windows.

A neon purple sign floods the lot with light.

A LINE of PEOPLE snakes from the entrance.

By the door, a massive BOUNCER (late 30s, Polynesian) checks a clipboard. He holds onto a purple velvet rope.

JERRY

Excuse me sir-

BOUNCER

(soft Kiwi accent)

End of the line, bro.

JERRY

I'm actually a detective. I'm with the city. Need to speak with your boss.

Bouncer looks up. Scans Jerry, takes in his nervous energy.

BOUNCER
Gotta badge?

Jerry pats his pockets - jacket, pants, jacket again. Fumbles for it in his jacket. Shows it to the bouncer

He barely looks at it.

BOUNCER
Aw sweet. Yeah, go ahead man.

The bouncer holds the door open for Jerry. Purple light flashing out. Bass pulsing. Jerry steps into--

48 INT. BLACK BAZAAR - CONTINUOUS

48

Jerry steps inside. Electronic club music pulsing, louder than expected.

JERRY
(to Bouncer)
Thanks.

Door closes behind him.

The club is packed. Hordes of people crowd around tables and couches. The dance floor a blur of bodies. Everything's washed in purple light.

Jerry tries to squeeze through the crowd.

He pinballs off dancers and drunk club-goers. Someone spills a drink on his jacket. He doesn't notice.

Jerry watches the dance floor. Bodies throwing themselves around to the beat.

In the crowd - a flash of Maya's hair. He turns. Not her.

There - Amanda's laugh. Wrong voice.

Even Mary's silhouette by the bar. A stranger.

Jerry stands still. The crowd flows around him.

His trance is broken by a guy running backwards into him.

CLUB DRUNK
Watch it dickbag!

JERRY
S-Sorry.

The club drunk wobbles back to his table. A group of people cheer him on as he falls over the table. Face first into a pile of coke.

Jerry continues pushing through until he emerges into a less crowded part near the back.

He leans over. Catches his breath. Adjusts his tie.

At the VIP section, the CLUB OWNER (60s, gray beard) holds court with several young women.

Jerry marches over. Stops at the velvet rope.

JERRY
Excuse me sir-

CLUB OWNER
(not looking up)
Hello young man, looking for a nice time, eh? You look like you need a good time. Let the boy in-

The club owner looks up at Jerry. Scratches his beard.

JERRY
I don't know if you remember from earlier-

CLUB OWNER
Wait a second. Aren't you the cop who harrassed by employee?

His face hardens.

CLUB OWNER
That was my nephew you bastard! In the security room!

JERRY
Sir, I just need-

CLUB OWNER
Get out. Out now!
(standing, to bartender)
Call security!

When he turns back to Jerry - gone. Swallowed by the crowd.

49 **EXT. BLACK BAZAAR - ALLEYWAY - NIGHT**

49

Jerry bursts out the side door.

He leans on the wall. Catches his breath.

His head falls back. Directly above him - a security camera.

Pointed down the alleyway at the exact angle from the Dmitri-Maya photo.

Jerry stares at it.

He heads back down the alley toward the street.

At the front door, there's a second bouncer now talking with the first one.

Jerry approaches. The new bouncer is even bigger.

JERRY

Uh, hey it's me.

BOUNCER

Aw 'sup man.

JERRY

Hey, yeah. I was wondering if you had security cameras on the front of the building.

BOUNCER

Just the one.

He points up to a camera right above the door.

JERRY

Nothing that captures the parking lot? The curb?

BOUNCER

Naw man. Just the one.

Jerry glances at a gnarly shark skull tattoo on his neck. Clears his throat.

JERRY

Mind if I ask you a few questions?

BOUNCER

Aw yeah, I'm just about to take my break.

(to other bouncer)

Night man, take care.

BOUNCER 2

See ya.

The bouncer starts walking. Jerry has to quickstep to keep up.

JERRY
How often do you work here?

BOUNCER
Most nights, for about a year.

JERRY
So you'd know the regulars.

BOUNCER
Aw yeah, totally.

They stop at the alley entrance. The bouncer leans against the brick wall, making Jerry look even smaller.

JERRY
Know a guy named Dmitri? He's bald.

BOUNCER
Aw yeah, I love that guy. Sweet dude.

Jerry furrows his brow.

JERRY
Sweet dude? He's... You sure we're talking about the same guy?

BOUNCER
Russian Dmitri? Yeah man, he's the best. Total party animal but he never causes trouble.

JERRY
(carefully)
Uh... Yeah. Does he ever... Take anyone home? Girls specifically?

BOUNCER
(chuckling)
Dmitri? Naw man. He's here till we close. Every time.

Jerry taps his pen against the notepad.

JERRY
So you've never seen him leave with anyone? In a cab or car?

BOUNCER
Naw. I even buy him an Uber sometimes. Heh.

JERRY
You buy him...? Why?

BOUNCER

Drinks too much. Gets too high.
Lotta reasons. But he's always good
for it with the money.

Jerry's pen hovers over his notepad. Jerry sways, dazed in confusion.

JERRY

Are there any girls he hangs out
with regularly? The names Amanda or
Maya ring any bells?

BOUNCER

Naw he doesn't hang out with girls
man. He's homosexual.

JERRY

Dmitri's gay?

Jerry clicks his pen.

BOUNCER

Aw yeah totally man.

JERRY

Then why would he be hanging out
with Maya in this alleyway?

Bouncer thinks about this. Really thinking.

BOUNCER

Weird, huh?

JERRY

Yes it is.

BOUNCER

Maybe she needed something? Dmitri
knows everyone. All the parties and
stuff.

JERRY

What do you mean?

BOUNCER

Like, he always knows where things
are happening. Who's throwing what
and when.

JERRY

So like... an information guy?

BOUNCER

I guess? I just know people ask him
stuff sometimes. Where to go, who to
talk to.

Jerry scribbles that down.

JERRY
You wouldn't happen to have his home address?

BOUNCER
Aw... Sorry man, I can't do that, I don't want to rat on my boy.

JERRY
Yeah... No, I understand. Thanks for your time.

BOUNCER
Totally man. Hope you find what you're looking for.

The bouncer heads back to the door. Jerry watches him go, then looks down at his notepad.

He's circled "GAY" next to a four times circled "DMITRI".

CUT TO:

50 **EXT. BLACK BAZAAR - PARKING LOT - NIGHT** 50

51 **LATER - MORNING** 51

Jerry is dead asleep inside his car. Mouth agape, saliva dripping off his chin.

A drunk homeless man hobbles up to the passenger side door.

He leans over the curb, falling on the hood. A loud thud.

Jerry's head slowly rocks back and forth. Eyes barely start to peel.

A STREAM OF PISS hits the passenger side window. The drunk man has propped himself against the car.

Jerry stretches in his seat. Wipes his chin and rubs his eyes.

He lays back down to catch one last second of sleep.

His head rocks to the right. His eyes widen.

JERRY
(mumbling)
What the...

He jolts awake.

JERRY
Hey! What the fuck!

The drunk man is whistling away, still pissing.

Jerry grabs some files from the passenger seat and tosses them at the window.

JERRY
Get the fuck out of here!

He looks at Jerry, giggles to himself. Hikes his pants up.

HOMELESS MAN
'Mornin to ya too!

The homeless man hobbles off.

Jerry sits up in his car, watching in awe.

He bunches up the papers, scattered around the car. Slides them back into their folder.

Props the seat back up, and buckles himself in. He inserts the keys and starts the car.

The digital clock on the dash flashes on: 9:27 AM.

Jerry leans forward in his seat exhausted.

He starts banging his head against the wheel.

52 INT. POLICE STATION - RECEPTION - MORNING

52

An analog clock on the wall reads 9:44, ticks over to 45.

The receptionist is hunched over her desk. Almost breathing on the monitor in front of her.

She looks up, through the glass doors.

Jerry is hustling up the stairs.

He bursts in the room out of breath. Hands on knees.

Wipes his feet on the entrance mat then marches forward.

Past the receptionist desk. The receptionist's eyes still tracking Jerry.

RECEPTIONIST
Greenish wants you.

Jerry comes to a halt. Adjusts his tie.

JERRY
For what?

RECEPTIONIST

Didn't say.

Jerry stares down the hallway. Takes a deep breath.

JERRY

Alright.

He continues off, pace a bit slower this time.

The receptionist is already back in her monitor. Hasn't noticed Jerry's left.

RECEPTIONIST

You gotta four letter word for-

She looks up.

RECEPTIONIST

Damn.

53 INT. POLICE STATION - CRIMINAL INVEST. - CONTINUOUS

53

Jerry pushes the door open with his shoulder. He stops just as he enters, staring into the office.

Staring back: Detectives Ramirez and Wentworth. Sitting at their desks, concerned looks.

Jerry continues through the office into-

54 GREENISH'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

54

Jerry carefully handles the door knob, enough so he can slide inside.

JERRY

Listen I'm really sorry lieutenant,
I got sidetracked following up on-

After closing the door behind him, Jerry sees Greenish is not seated at his desk.

He looks around the office: window blinds are drawn, cracked enough so that rays of light cut through the office.

Silhouetted by these rays, a man. A stout, big-bodied man. His husky voice rumbles out in the office:

VOICE

Have a seat Jerry.

Jerry's expression is beyond confusion. He carefully takes a seat, gaze locked on the man.

The man heaves a cough into his elbow. Wipes his forehead with a handkerchief. He turns around to Jerry.

The man (60s) has a balding gray head of hair. Wears a navy blue suit, red tie, and a white shirt that is stressing at the buttons.

VOICE

You know who I am son?

Jerry leans closer to get a better view of his face. A pin on the man's lapel catches a ray of light and flashes Jerry. An American flag pin.

JERRY

You look familiar.

VOICE

Don't watch the news, huh? No social media?

The man walks behind Greenish's desk. Stops under a photo that catches Jerry's eye: Greenish shaking hands with the man.

JERRY

You're the mayor?

MAYOR LUPREEDY

And would you have a modicum of an idea as to why your Mayor has taken time out of his busy schedule to meet with you-

He reads a line off a paper in front of him.

MAYOR LUPREEDY

Detective Jerry Lefton.

JERRY

Well I mean if I had to, uh, guess sir--it would probably be... it would probably be that, um, case. Should I--am I okay, I mean--are we okay to talk about the case, uh-

MAYOR LUPREEDY

My wife's case.

JERRY

Yeah that one, so I guess it's cool if we talk about it-

MAYOR LUPREEDY

(growing anger)

My wife's case Jerry! Are you
(MORE)

MAYOR LUPREEDY (CONT'D)
anywhere close to closing my wife's
case at all?!

Jerry swallows, adjusts his tie.

JERRY
Well, I'm getting somewhere, I'd
say. It's just tough- Greenish said
that I'm the only one who should be
working on this, and that, uh, I
shouldn't talk about this with
anyone? Not to be a snitch on my own
boss but it seems like he hasn't put
a lot of care-

MAYOR LUPREEDY
Jerry I'll give you your props where
they are due. Hassling that boy for
the man's address was a great start.
So you know where the man lives,
what work is there to do detective?
It's a pretty shut and close case
I'd say. What in Saint Mary's name
could you have possibly been doing
these past couple days, besides
dawdling?

JERRY
Sorry.

MAYOR LUPREEDY
I told Greenish to make this easy on
you. This should be a layup for your
career Jerry! I'm trying to help you
out son.

JERRY
I'm not sure I- sir, a lot of the
work I've done so far, this whole
thing is way more complicated than
the case file.

MAYOR LUPREEDY
Complicated? The only thing
complicating this case is you
detective.

JERRY
But sir I-

MAYOR LUPREEDY
Do I have to do your damn job for
you? Let me make this very easy for
you detective: find this Dmitri
fella that was fraternizing with my
wife, and arrest that motherfucker.

JERRY

Well mister... Mayor, I have good reason to believe Dmitri had nothing to do with the disappearance of your wife.

The mayor leans back in his seat, stares out the window.

JERRY

(awkward)

I mean, sure I don't know where she could be but, uh, at least we know she might not be kidnapped. Silver lining way of things I guess being that there's a higher chance your wife will be found-

Mayor Lupreedy slams his fist on the desk. Rises over Jerry in a rage.

MAYOR LUPREEDY

Can't you just arrest that damn commie bastard that took my wife!

Jerry sits back, stares at his lap.

The mayor catches his breath. Fixes a button that came undone on his shirt.

MAYOR LUPREEDY

(calmer)

Sorry to yell at you son. But this is how the job is, okay? Now let's close this case and just be done with all this nastiness.

He starts for the door. Jerry interrupts him:

JERRY

But, she's your wife...

Mayor lays a hand on his shoulder.

A single tear falls down his cheek.

MAYOR LUPREEDY

You're a good guy Jerry. That's rare in this world so, let's keep it that way.

The mayor leaves out the room. Jerry is stunned.

He takes a moment to collect himself.

Greenish bursts into the room. Coffee in hand.

LT. GREENISH
How'd yer meeting with the Mayor go
Lefton?

Jerry sits still.

LT. GREENISH
Can you turn the light on, on your
way out Detective, creepin' me out
there, sitting in the dark like
that.

Jerry snaps out of it. Get's up to leave.

JERRY
S-Sorry about that sir. I'll go.

55 **INT. POLICE STATION - CRIMINAL INVEST. - CONTINUOUS** 55

Jerry steps back into the office. Both detectives are now gone.

He walks over to his desk. A post-it placed at the center.

It reads an address. Under it the name: DMITRI ONGLESTOV.